

BJT Summary

Operating Modes

npn				pnp			
Active region of npn BJT:				Active region of pnp BJT:			
Mode of Operation	Emitter-Base Junction	Collector-Base Junction	Application	Mode of Operation	Emitter-Base Junction	Collector-Base Junction	Applications
Cut-off	Reverse biased (VBE < 0 for npn)	Reverse biased (VBC < 0 for npn)	Logic - OFF State	Cut-off	Reverse biased (VEB < 0 for pnp)	Reverse biased (VCB < 0 for pnp)	Logic - OFF State
Forward Active	Forward biased (VBE > 0 for npn)	Reverse biased (VBC < 0 for npn)	Amplifier	Forward Active	Forward biased (VEB > 0 for pnp)	Reverse biased (VCB < 0 for pnp)	Amplifier
Saturation	Forward biased (VBE > 0 for npn)	Forward biased (VBC > 0 for npn)	Logic - ON State	Saturation	Forward biased (VEB > 0 for pnp)	Forward biased (VCB > 0 for pnp)	Logic - ON State
Reverse Active	Reverse Biased (VBE < 0 for npn)	Forward Biased (VBC > 0 for npn)	Not used	Reverse Active	Reverse Biased (VEB < 0 for pnp)	Forward Biased (VCB > 0 for pnp)	Not used

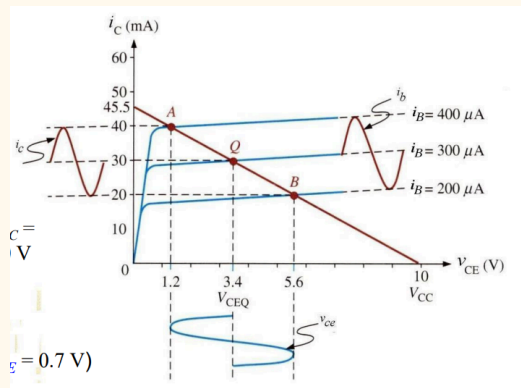
Forward Active IV Characteristics

Without Early Effect	With Early Effect (VA ~ 100-200V)
$i_C = I_S e^{v_{BE}/V_T}$ $i_B = \frac{I_S}{\beta} e^{v_{BE}/V_T}$	$i_C = I_S e^{v_{BE}/V_T} \left(1 + \frac{v_{CE}}{V_A}\right)$ $i_B = \frac{I_S}{\beta} e^{v_{BE}/V_T} \left(1 + \frac{v_{CE}}{V_A}\right)$

$i_E = i_C + i_B \approx i_C$	$i_C = \beta i_B$	$i_E = (\beta + 1) i_B$	$i_E = \left(\frac{1}{\beta} + 1\right) i_C$
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$\alpha = \beta / (1 + \beta)$

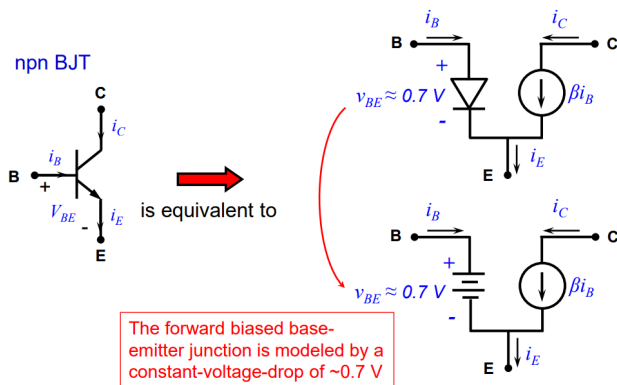
Modelling



DC

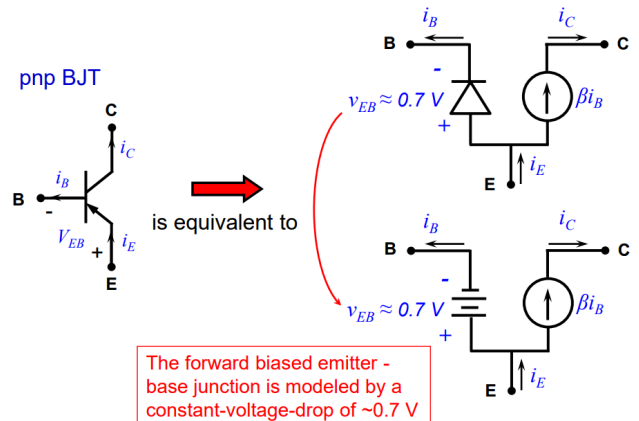
npn

As the emitter-base junction is forward biased, $V_{BE} \approx 0.7$ V, it can be modeled by a constant voltage source (using the constant-voltage-drop model for a forward biased pn-junction).



pnp

Large-signal model of a pnp BJT: polarities of voltages and directions of currents are opposite to those of an npn BJT.



- direction of current source and voltage drop is opposite

Thevenin Equivalent Method

- Check npn or pnp
- Assumption:
 - BJT is under forward active mode $\Rightarrow I_C = \beta I_B$
- Model base biasing circuit by Thevenin equivalent
- With the Thevenin equivalent, find base current
- With base current and β find collector current
- With collector current find emitter current and collector voltage
- Check operating mode to verify assumption
 - for npn: $V_{BE} > 0.7$ V, emitter-base is forward biased & $V_{BC} < 0$ V, base-collector is reverse biased
 - for pnp: $V_{EB} > 0.7$ V, emitter-base is forward biased & $V_{CB} < 0$ V, base-collector is reverse biased

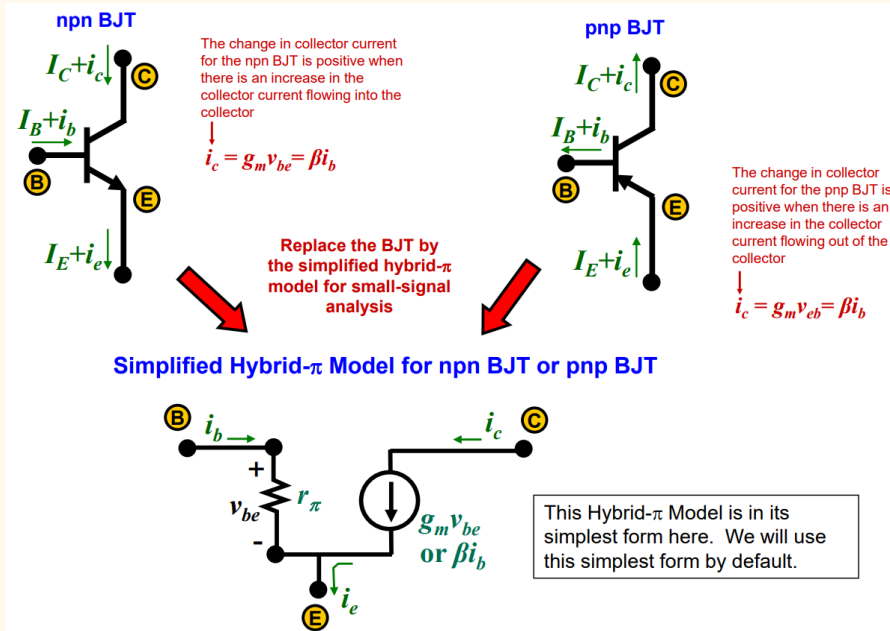
Voltage divider method

- Check npn or pnp
- Assumption:
 - BJT is under forward active mode $\Rightarrow I_C = \beta I_B$
 - Biassing circuit current $\gg$ Base current $\Rightarrow$ base voltage can be easily found
- From potential divider, find base voltage
- From base voltage and 0.7 V drop, find emitter voltage
- From emitter voltage and emitter resistor, find emitter current
- From emitter current and β , find collector current and base current
- From collector current and collector resistor find collector voltage
- Check base current and biassing circuit current to verify assumption 2
 - if biassing circuit current is not 10x of base current, redo analysis with Thevenin method
- Check operating mode to verify assumption 1

- a. for npn: $V_{BE} > 0.7$ V, emitter-base is forward biased & $V_{BC} < 0$ V, base-collector is reverse biased
b. for pnp: $V_{EB} > 0.7$ V, emitter-base is forward biased & $V_{CB} < 0$ V, base-collector is reverse biased

AC

Simplified Hybrid- π Model



$$r_{\pi} = r_i$$

EE2027 used r_{π}
EE5507 used r_i

$$\beta = g_m r_{\pi}$$

- ✱ Its easy to remember this
- ✱ Wherever the input current is, it goes into r_{π} and generate a voltage
- ✱ Output current is depending on the voltage via g_m
- ✱ So, the overall current gain is simply $g_m r_{\pi}$

No Early Effect

$$i_c = I_S e^{v_{BE}/V_T}$$

Parameters

$$g_m = \text{Transconductance}$$

$$g_m = \frac{I_C}{V_T}$$

$$r_{\pi} = \text{input resistance}$$

$$r_{\pi} = \frac{\beta V_T}{I_C}$$

$$\beta = g_m r_{\pi}$$

$$r_{\pi} = \frac{\beta}{g_m}$$

$$g_m = \frac{\beta}{r_{\pi}}$$

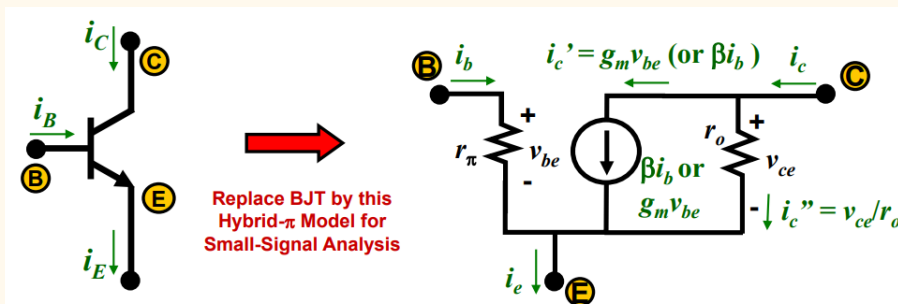
Relationships

$$i_c = g_m v_{be}$$

$$v_{be} = r_{\pi} i_b$$

$$i_c = \beta i_b$$

Full Hybrid- π Model with Early Effect



Early Effect

$$i_c = I_S e^{v_{BE}/V_T} \left(1 + \frac{v_{CE}}{V_A}\right)$$

Additional Parameter

$$r_o = \text{output resistance}$$

$$r_o = \frac{V_A}{I_C}$$

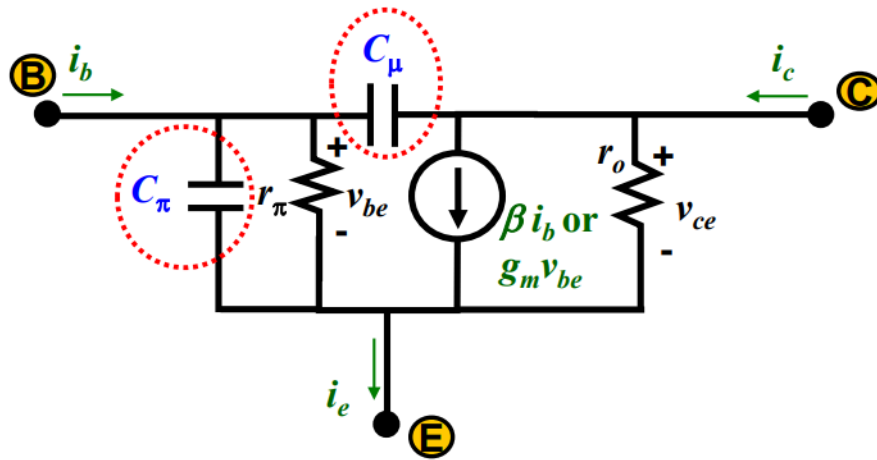
$$r_o = \infty \text{ if } V_A \text{ not given}$$

Relationships

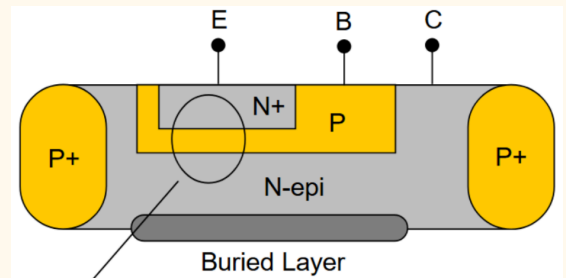
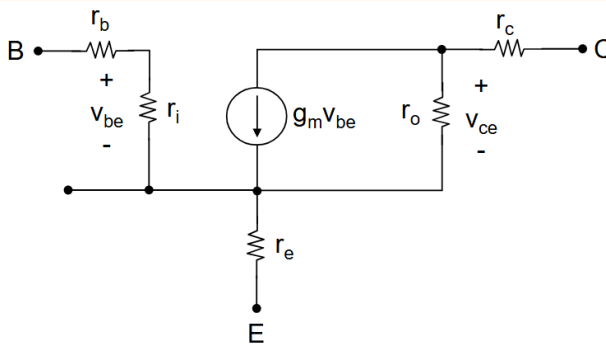
$$i_c = g_m v_{be} + \frac{1}{r_o} v_{ce}$$

$$i_c = \beta i_b + \frac{1}{r_o} v_{ce}$$

Full Hybrid- π Model at High Frequency (EE2027)



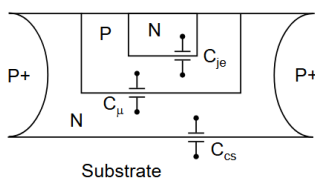
Full Hybrid- π Model at Low Frequency (EE5507)



r_e is small, because the emitter is on top and lightly dope
 r_c is non negligible without the buried layer
 r_b can be minimised with fingers, like R_g in MOSFET, see [here](#)

Full Hybrid- π Model at High Frequency (EE5507)

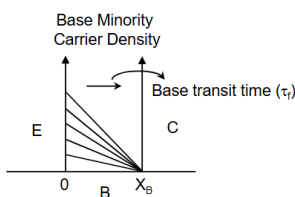
- Junction Capacitance (C_{je} , C_{μ} , C_{cs})



$$C_j = \frac{C_{j0}}{\sqrt[m]{1 + \frac{V_{Bias}}{\phi_{bi}}}} \quad m \approx \frac{1}{3} \sim \frac{1}{2}$$

C_{je} : forward bias
 C_{μ} , C_{cs} : reverse bias

- Base Charging Capacitance (C_b)



$$\Delta Q_n = i_c \cdot \tau_F$$

$$\Delta Q_n = C_b \cdot v_{be}$$

$$\Delta Q_n = \Delta Q_h \quad \leftarrow \text{Charge Neutrality}$$

$$\Rightarrow C_b = \tau_F \cdot \frac{i_c}{v_{be}} = \tau_F \cdot g_m$$

$$\approx 250 \text{ ps} \cdot \frac{1}{26 \Omega} = 10 \text{ pF}$$

Diffusion = Base Charging capacitance
 $\gg$ In NPN, base is forward bias then a lot electron injected into base then get sweep to the collector.

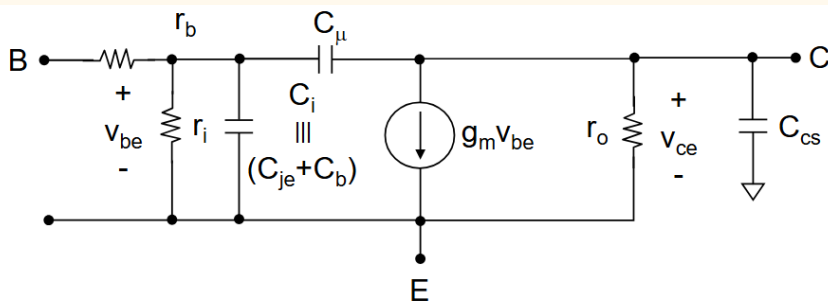
$\gg$ Base terminal will have +ve charge, then the negative electron is in the base region.

$\gg$ Turning BJT off will not off instantly, it take time for electrons to move from base region and get collected by the collector.

$\gg$ This is called transit time, τ_F
 $\gg$ Can deduce the diffusion capacitance from transit time

$\gg$ Dominant factor for the BJT speed

make the E to C width thinner = base width thinner, then BJT faster



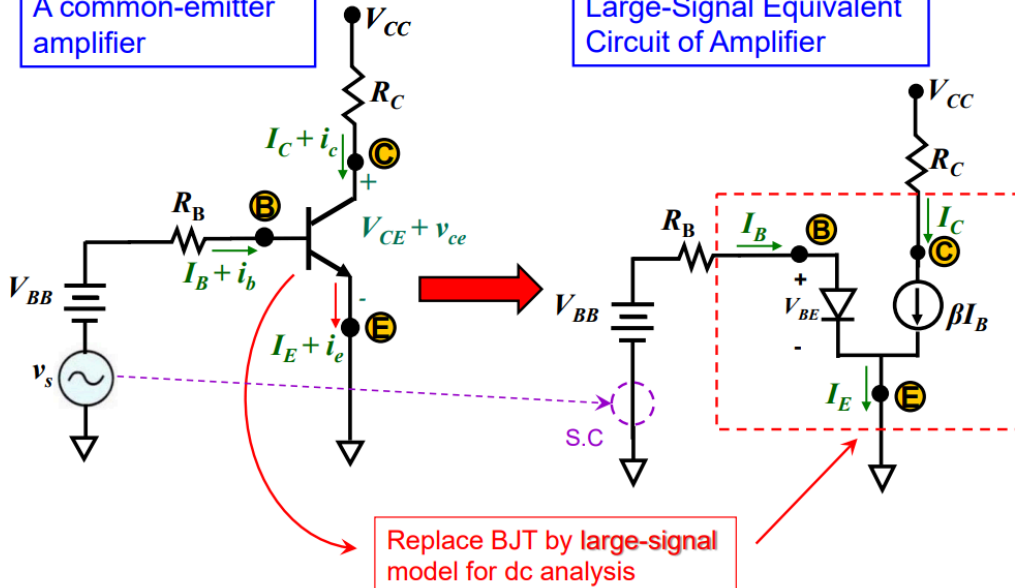
$$C_b \gg C_{je}$$

Full Analysis

- The dc bias point of the amplifier can be determined using the **large-signal** equivalent circuit, in the **absence** of the ac (small signal) source, v_s .

A common-emitter amplifier

Large-Signal Equivalent Circuit of Amplifier



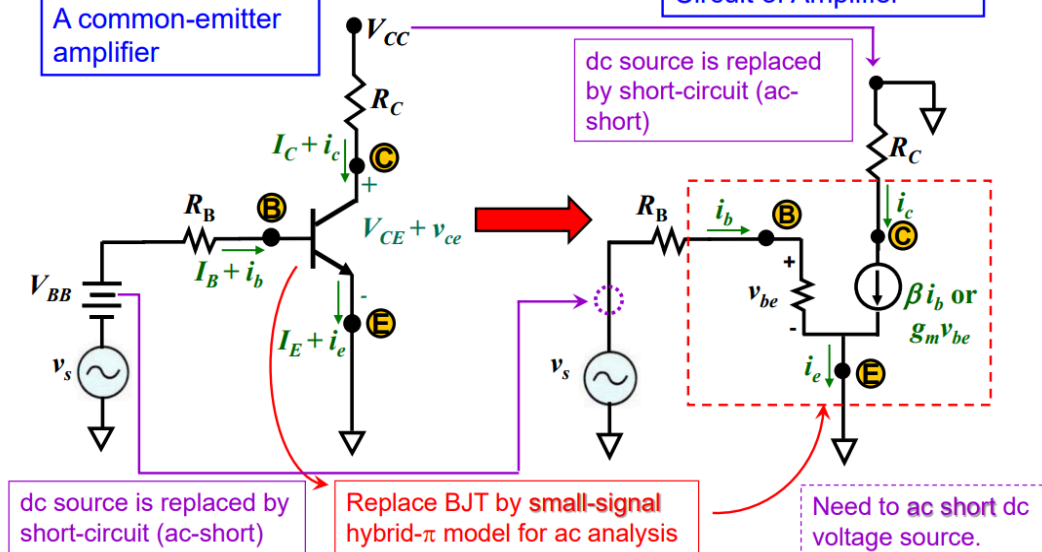
Turn off AC source and perform DC analysis to obtain DC biasing point

I_C is used to find the small signal parameters

- The small-signal ac analysis of the amplifier is carried out using the **small-signal** equivalent circuit, and dc voltage sources need to be ac short.

A common-emitter amplifier

Small-Signal Equivalent Circuit of Amplifier



Turn off DC source, this includes the V_{CC}

Perform AC analysis

$\beta = 100$ $R_B = 10\text{ k}\Omega$ $V_{BB} = 3.7\text{ V}$ $R_C = 220\ \Omega$ $V_{CC} = 10\text{ V}$ (Assume $V_{BE} = 0.7\text{ V}$)	Correct Biasing No distortion from clipping or non linearity
$\beta = 100$ $R_B = 7.5\text{ k}\Omega$ $V_{BB} = 3.7\text{ V}$ $R_C = 220\ \Omega$ $V_{CC} = 10\text{ V}$ (Assume $V_{BE} = 0.7\text{ V}$)	Biasing Too High Distortion from non linearity due to entering saturation region
$\beta = 100$ $R_B = 30\text{ k}\Omega$ $V_{BB} = 3.7\text{ V}$ $R_C = 220\ \Omega$ $V_{CC} = 10\text{ V}$ (Assume $V_{BE} = 0.7\text{ V}$)	Biasing Too Low Distortion from clipping due to entering cut-off region